

Not the Apple of your eye?

It's unfortunate, but perhaps justified, that the only two things people know about Apple is that they make great products and that said products are almost always unaffordable. Sure, it's a big company, and it had some iconic Jobs fellow (don't flay us, fanboys), and their laptops are really thin and shiny and futuristic, but if they're unaffordable why should most people bother? Nonchalance seems like a perfectly reasonable attitude to have, which is pretty much what the overarching sentiment in the *non-fanboy* world is.

Why is it unfortunate then? Well, as lovers of technology, it becomes kind of hypocritical to close our eyes and ears to perspectives that we pre-judge as unworthwhile. The scientific temper directs us to be impartial in our arguments *before* being unequivocal in our judgement. And how, indeed, can we do that, if our only argument against Apple is the lightness of our wallets?

In all fairness, Apple is an impressive company, and one that operates differently from most. There's a design-focus in its products that is unparalleled in the industry; there's an interest not just in features but in how those features will be used, a truly holistic design sense – embedded deep within the company values. It's really this that the Apple customer (often more than willingly) pays for.

With those kind of ethos in place, what ends up happening is that Apple, almost always takes the pole position in technological innovation. It is willing to go smaller, brighter, sharper, faster than a lot of other companies. And being the juggernaut that it is, often entire industry trends are started and propelled by Apple (for better or for worse).